

● COLD OPEN

THE OBJECTION PACK

12 cold call objections and the
exact words that beat them.

MECHANICS, NOT MOTIVATION

How to use this

Every objection below has four parts: what they're **actually** saying, the **move**, the **exact words**, and what to **never** say.

Three rules before you start:

1. **Don't argue with a reflex.** Most objections in the first ten seconds fire before the prospect has processed a single word you said. They're not rejecting your offer — they're rejecting an interruption. Arguing with a reflex confirms you're the thing they wanted to get rid of.
2. **Agree, then redirect.** Resistance needs something to push against. Remove it and there's nothing to push. Every script here starts by conceding.
3. **Specificity is the whole game.** "We help companies improve efficiency" gets hung up on. "You've got four SDRs and no call recording" doesn't. Vague is what a salesperson sounds like. Specific is what a person who did homework sounds like.

1. "Not interested."

What they're actually saying: *"I don't know what this is and I want the interruption to stop."* Fires in under two seconds — before comprehension.

The move: Agree completely. Then hand them one concrete detail they can actually evaluate.

"Totally fair — you have no idea who I am yet. I'll be quick: I'm calling because you've got four SDRs and no call recording, which usually means nobody knows why the good calls went well. Is that roughly right?"

Why it works: "Totally fair" removes the thing to push against. The specific detail proves you did homework, which is the only real credential on a cold call. The closing question is easy to answer and costs nothing.

Never say: "Just give me 30 seconds." You already took the 30 seconds. Asking permission twice signals you know you're an intrusion.

2. "Send me an email."

What they're actually saying: Two completely different things — and you have to find out which. Either *"this is a polite no"* or *"I'm genuinely busy."*

The move: One diagnostic question. Their answer tells you which one it is.

"Happy to. So I don't send you something useless — what would need to be in it for you to actually reply?"

Why it works: A polite no can't answer this. They'll say "just send whatever" — that's your answer, it was a no, stop spending time. A genuinely busy person tells you exactly what to write, and now you have a warm email instead of one that dies in a filter.

Never say: "What's your email?" You already have it. Asking proves you didn't prepare and hands them an easy fake.

3. "We already have a vendor."

What they're actually saying: Usually the truth. That's fine — most of your market is already buying something. Incumbency is not loyalty.

The move: Never attack the incumbent. Look for the gap instead.

"Good — I'd be worried if you didn't. I'm not calling to replace them. What would have to change about your setup this year for you to even look at something else?"

Why it works: Attacking their vendor attacks their past decision, and people defend their decisions harder than they defend their vendors. "What would have to change" is future-focused and non-threatening, and it gets them describing their own gap out loud. If nothing would have to change, you've saved yourself a quarter of follow-up.

Never say: "What don't you like about them?" It invites loyalty. People defend what they've chosen, even when they hate it.

4. "It's too expensive."

What they're actually saying: Almost never that the number is too big. It's one of two things: value isn't clear, or you're talking to someone who doesn't own the budget.

The move: Find out which before you touch the price.

"That's fair. Is it too expensive compared to something specific, or is it more that it's hard to justify right now?"

Why it works: "Compared to what" means you have a competitor and a value conversation. "Hard to justify" means you have a business case problem or the wrong person. Two completely different calls. Discounting before you know which one you're in is how you give away margin to someone who was never going to buy.

Never say: "I can probably do something on price." You just taught them the first number was fake, and every number after it is now negotiable.

5. "How did you get my number?"

What they're actually saying: *"I'm slightly annoyed and testing whether you'll be weird about it."*

The move: Flat, boring honesty. Then move on immediately without apologizing.

"It's on your company site. I was looking at your team page because I noticed you're hiring three more reps — that's actually why I called."

Why it works: Everyone panics on this one, which is exactly why calm honesty disarms it. Defensiveness confirms you did something shady. The immediate pivot means you don't linger in the awkward part, and the reason for the call arrives before they can ask again.

Never say: "Sorry, I can take you off the list." You've conceded you're spam and ended your own call.

6. "Call me back next quarter."

What they're actually saying: Usually *"no, but I don't want to say no."* Occasionally it's real. One question separates them.

The move: Make the future specific. Vagueness is where no's hide.

"Sure. So it's actually useful when I call — what's changing next quarter that makes it a better time?"

Why it works: A real timing objection has a real reason: budget cycle, headcount, a contract ending. They'll tell you and now you have a genuine reason to call back. A soft no has no answer, and you'll hear it in the pause. Either way you learn something in one sentence.

Never say: "Great, I'll follow up then." That's how you build a pipeline of appointments with people who will never take your call.

7. "Now's a bad time / I'm in a meeting."

What they're actually saying: Sometimes literally true. Often the softest available brush-off.

The move: Believe them, but leave with something. Don't just hang up empty.

"No problem. Two options — I let you go and call Thursday morning, or you give me fifteen seconds now and you'll know if it's even relevant. Your call."

Why it works: Giving a genuine choice — including the option to end it — removes the pressure that makes people say no reflexively. Most people take the fifteen seconds, because fifteen seconds is genuinely nothing and now it's their decision instead of your imposition.

Never say: "When's a better time?" They'll say a time, they won't be there, and you'll have burned a callback slot on a ghost.

8. "I'm not the right person."

What they're actually saying: Either true, or the easiest exit available.

The move: Accept it instantly, then get the referral before they hang up. Speed matters — you have about three seconds.

"That's helpful, thanks. Who owns it — and would you mind if I mentioned you pointed me their way?"

Why it works: No resistance means no reason to hang up. And that second half is the whole play — an internal referral converts several times better than a cold dial. Asking permission to use their name almost always gets a yes, because you've made it feel like a favor rather than a leak.

Never say: "Well, maybe you could pass this along?" You've handed your job to someone with zero incentive to do it.

9. "Just send me some information."

What they're actually saying: *"I want this to end without being rude."* Distinct from "send me an email" — this one wants a brochure, which is a deflection.

The move: Trade. Information for one piece of information.

"I can do that. Generic decks are useless though — answer one question and I'll send you the part that's actually relevant. How are you handling [specific thing] right now?"

Why it works: It reframes you from a person sending spam into a person solving something. And if they won't answer one question, they were never going to read the deck — you've saved yourself the send and the follow-up.

Never say: "Sure, what's your email?" See #2.

10. "We're happy with what we have."

What they're actually saying: *"I have no active pain and you haven't given me a reason to look."* Different from #3 — this isn't about a vendor, it's about inertia.

The move: Don't challenge the happiness. Introduce a specific they may not have considered.

"Makes sense — most people are until something breaks. Quick one: when your reps miss quota, do you know which part of the call it fell apart in? That's the bit that usually isn't covered."

Why it works: "Most people are until something breaks" agrees and plants a seed simultaneously. The question is specific enough that they have to actually think, and the honest answer for most teams is "no, we don't know" — which creates the gap without you claiming anything about their current setup.

Never say: "Are you sure?" You've called them wrong about their own business in three words.

11. "We don't have budget."

What they're actually saying: Usually *"this isn't a priority."* Budget appears fast for things that are.

The move: Separate priority from money. They're not the same objection.

"Understood. If budget weren't the issue at all — is this something you'd actually want fixed this year, or is it genuinely not a priority?"

Why it works: It gives them permission to say "not a priority," which is the honest answer and saves you months. And if they say they *would* want it fixed, you're no longer having a budget conversation — you're having a business case conversation, which is a conversation you can win.

Never say: "When does budget free up?" Same trap as #6 — a specific-sounding date that doesn't exist.

12. "Is this a sales call?"

What they're actually saying: *"I'm testing whether you'll lie to me."*

The move: Yes. Immediately, with zero hedging, and keep going.

"Yes. Thirty seconds and you'll know if it's worth your time — after that I'll get off the phone either way."

Why it works: This is the single highest-leverage moment on any cold call. They expect a dodge. Everyone dodges. Not dodging is so unusual that it buys real attention, and it establishes you as someone who says true things — which is worth more than any script. The "I'll get off the phone either way" is what makes the thirty seconds feel safe to give.

Never say: "Well, it's more of a courtesy call." You've confirmed you're a salesperson *and* a dishonest one, in one sentence.

The pattern underneath all twelve

Every script above does the same three things in the same order:

1. **Concede** — remove the thing they're pushing against
2. **Specify** — one concrete detail that proves you're not reading a list
3. **Ask something easy** — a question that costs nothing to answer

That's the whole method. If you memorize nothing else, memorize the order. You can build a response to an objection that isn't in this pack by running those three steps in sequence.

More at Cold Open — daily cold call teardowns, objection scripts, and the mechanics nobody teaches. Mechanics, not motivation.